

Visa Africa Accelerator — Early Expression of Interest (Cohort 7)

To: Visa Africa Accelerator Program Team | africa.visa.com

VISA AFRICA ACCELERATOR PROGRAM — EARLY EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

Cohort 7 | Pre-Application Partnership Outreach

To: Visa Africa Fintech Accelerator Program Team

Via: africa.visa.com | Plug and Play Tech Center Partnership

From: Tom Ugbodaga, Founder & CEO, BETONIQ(WEST) Limited

Email: zeropointfeild_nonwnt@zeropay.site Phone: +234 706 525 2117 Date: July 23, 2026

SUBJECT: Early Expression of Interest — ZeroPay | Visa Africa Accelerator Cohort 7 | World's First Offline-First NFC Payment Protocol

Dear Visa Africa Accelerator Program Team,

I am writing ahead of the Cohort 7 application window to introduce ZeroPay — a technology that I believe is uniquely aligned with Visa's global mission to enable universal access to digital payments.

I am Tom Ugbodaga, Founder and CEO of BETONIQ(WEST) Limited (CAC No. 56802, Abuja, Nigeria), and the sole inventor of ZeroPay — the world's first offline-first, uncapped NFC contactless payment protocol.

I am writing now, before the window opens, because I believe the Visa Africa Accelerator team should have the opportunity to evaluate ZeroPay before it enters the formal applicant pool. What ZeroPay does is directly relevant to a problem that has limited Visa's reach in Africa for three decades.

THE VISA PROBLEM THAT ZEROPAY SOLVES

Visa's contactless payment technology is the most widely deployed in the world. But in Sub-Saharan Africa — Visa's fastest-growing market — that technology has a hard ceiling. The moment the internet goes down, Visa-branded contactless payments stop.

In Lagos, Abuja, Accra, and across 54 African markets, this is not an edge case. It is a daily reality. Network outages, intermittent connectivity, and patchy 4G coverage mean that merchants revert to cash multiple times every day — even when they have a Visa-accepting POS terminal.

Visa enforces a £100/\$200 offline contactless limit globally because without internet, there is no mechanism to authenticate high-value transactions. That limit has excluded Africa's informal economy from the full utility of Visa's global network.

ZeroPay removes that limit permanently.

THE ZEROPAY TECHNOLOGY

ZeroPay processes fully authenticated contactless payments of any value with zero internet connectivity using a patent-pending four-layer cryptographic architecture:

Layer 1 — NFC Communication: ISO 14443-A/B — the same standard underpinning every Visa payWave transaction globally.

Layer 2 — PUF Hardware Authentication: Physical Unclonable Function — silicon-level device identity that requires no server, no internet, and cannot be cloned or replicated.

Layer 3 — ECC P-256 Offline Signing: The same cryptographic standard used by Visa's own backend infrastructure — applied at point of sale, offline, without any network dependency.

Layer 4 — Distance Bounding Protocol: The first implementation of nanosecond-precision relay-attack prevention at point-of-sale scale globally.

The result: A Visa-compatible transaction — same security standard, same cryptographic trust — without the network dependency that has limited Visa's Africa expansion.

WHY THIS IS A VISA OPPORTUNITY

ZeroPay is not a competitor to Visa. It is the offline protocol layer that makes Visa's network work in the 40% of African markets where connectivity is absent or unreliable.

The partnership we are proposing is architectural: ZeroPay provides the offline authentication and token generation layer. Visa's settlement network handles the final clearing and settlement when connectivity is restored. Every ZeroPay transaction ultimately settles through Visa's global rails.

This is not a fintech startup trying to compete with Visa. This is the technology that extends Visa into the last mile of Africa's payment market — where cash currently dominates and Visa cannot reach.

THE ACCELERATOR REQUEST

We are requesting early consideration for the Visa Africa Accelerator Cohort 7 program, including:

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1. An introductory call with the Visa Africa partnerships and technology team this week to present the ZeroPay offline demo.
 2. Early access to the Cohort 7 application to ensure ZeroPay is fully evaluated when the program opens.
 3. Visa API partnership access — specifically the Visa Developer Platform — to begin building the ZeroPay-to-Visa settlement bridge prior to formal accelerator onboarding.
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CURRENT STATUS

Patent-pending invention disclosure: April 2026 Paystack settlement integration: Agreement signed July 14, 2026 (Cohort 7 will upgrade this to Visa-direct) CBN PSSP licence application: In progress Pre-Series A fundraising: \$4.5M target | Active conversations with Algebra Ventures and Atomico CAC Registration: BETONIQ(WEST) Limited, No. 56802, Abuja, FCT, Nigeria

THE FOUNDER

Tom Ugbodaga MSc — NFC for Contactless Technology in Financial Transactions, University of Gloucestershire, England, 2011 (Top Graduate, Best Result in Cohort) MSc — Computer Security Systems BSc Physics, Nigeria

The ZeroPay protocol is the 15-year commercialisation of world-class academic research in NFC security. I am not a software developer who discovered payments. I am an NFC security scientist who spent 15 years waiting for the right moment to commercialise this technology. That moment is now.

I look forward to your response.

Warm regards,

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